Basic — a Streamlit UI — Hints

> Back to the exercise · Hint 1 · Hint 2 · Solution

- Hint 1 — widgets are function calls
- Hint 2 — chat needs session_state

Hint 1 — widgets are function calls

A Streamlit app is a normal Python script. Each widget is a function that returns its current value:

```
import streamlit as st
from pipeline import classify
st.title("Sentiment Classifier")
text = st.text_input("Type something:")
if st.button("Classify"):
    st.write(classify(text))
```

Run it with `streamlit run app_streamlit.py`. The whole script re-runs top to bottom every time the user clicks — there are no routes and no server code to write. Guard the empty case: `if text.strip():` before calling the pipeline.

Hint 2 — chat needs session_state

Because the script re-runs on every interaction, a chatbot would forget the conversation — unless you store it in `st.session_state`, which survives re-runs:

```
if "messages" not in st.session_state:
    st.session_state["messages"] = []
# render each past message with st.chat_message(role)
user_text = st.chat_input("Say something")
if user_text:
    append {role: user, content: user_text}
    append {role: assistant, content: classify(user_text)}
    st.rerun()
```

`st.chat_message` / `st.chat_input` are the built-in chat widgets, and `st.session_state["messages"]` is the memory. That's the whole front end for an agent. The full

code is in the Solution.